THE FIRST LESSONS:
An Apprenticeship as a Sequence a Storyboard Can Follow.

The Rule: A sober mind must be tricked into the path. No sane person volunteers to dismantle their reality.

The Shape of the First Trick: A decoy maneuver. The teacher assigns a pseudo-task to trap the apprentice's attention, bypassing their reason. The trick is to hide the actual lesson inside an absurd physical demand.

Only a crackpot would undertake the task... of his own accord.

Sources: A Separate Reality, Tales of Power, The Power of Silence

Gemini Notebook

Source: The Teachings of Don Juan

TASK SET ALONE	Locate a specific, unmarked space on a small porch (12x8 feet) where one feels “naturally happy and strong.” The teacher issues the riddle and walks away.
WHAT THE APPRENTICE PHYSICALLY DOES	Paces the floor. Rolls systematically on his stomach, then his back. Sweeps the periphery of his vision and crosses his eyes to see separately, staring until a uniform chartreuse hue turns intensely purple.
WHAT THE TEACHER REFUSES TO EXPLAIN	The criteria for differentiation. The exact mechanics of how a physical space stores or drains energy (the sitio vs. the enemy).
THE PASS MARK	An involuntary physical recoil from the “enemy” spot—arched legs, trunk bent forward, hands contracted into claws—followed by falling into a deep, replenishing sleep on the “good” spot.

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Source: Tales of Power / Journey to Ixtlan

TASK SET ALONE	Arrange firewood in exact patterns, sweep debris aimlessly from one place to another, or encircle a house with unbroken, concentric lines drawn in the dirt with a finger.
WHAT THE APPRENTICE PHYSICALLY DOES	Executes absurd, repetitive manual labor in total isolation. Performs the actions meticulously without any functional or practical purpose.
WHAT THE TEACHER REFUSES TO EXPLAIN	That these physical acts are a subterfuge to teach "acting just for the hell of it"—acting impeccably without believing in the act or expecting any reward.
THE PASS MARK	The apprentice establishes the senseless chore as a serious, unquestioned, and perfect routine—at which exact moment, the teacher orders it dropped instantly.

Gemini Notebook

Source: Tales of Power

TASK SET ALONE	Walk in a specific, unaccustomed manner for long distances through harsh, mountainous terrain.
WHAT THE APPRENTICE PHYSICALLY DOES	Curls fingers into unaccustomed shapes to draw attention to the arms. Keeps eyes unfocused, sweeping a continuous visual arc from the tips of the feet to just above the horizon.
WHAT THE TEACHER REFUSES TO EXPLAIN	That the sheer volume of visual data “floods the tonal” (the rational mind), rendering it utterly incapable of talking to itself.
THE PASS MARK	The internal dialogue completely stops. A sudden, absolute mental silence is achieved.

Gemini Notebook

Source: Journey to Ixtlan / The Second Ring of Power

TASK SET ALONE	Stare unblinkingly at a pile of dry leaves, the shadows of rocks, or a distant geological feature (a water canyon) for hours.
WHAT THE APPRENTICE PHYSICALLY DOES	Sits propped against a tree. Uses a hat brim as a visor. Half-closes the eyelids to create a web of light on the lashes. Scans counterclockwise without focusing the eyes, breathing heavily from the abdomen.
WHAT THE TEACHER REFUSES TO EXPLAIN	That prolonged gazing forces the “assemblage point” to shift, bypassing normal vision to hook the “second attention” and pull the perceiver into the unknown.
THE PASS MARK	The object gazed at darkens, changes shape, reveals a hidden hole, or completely engulfs the apprentice’s field of vision in sudden blackness.

Gemini Notebook

Source: Journey to Ixtlan

TASK SET ALONE	Interact strictly with the shadows of things–the shadow of a pebble or the "lines of the world"–rather than the solid objects themselves.
WHAT THE APPRENTICE PHYSICALLY DOES	Lies down. Bends the right arm at the elbow. Curves the fingers as if holding a doorknob. Moves the arm back and forth in a circular motion,physically pushing against an imaginary, opposing force.
WHAT THE TEACHER REFUSES TO EXPLAIN	That it does not matter if the premise is objectively true or false; the only goal is to act with total commitment to achieve "not-doing."
THE PASS MARK	The hand becomes ice cold. The physical sensation of a heavy, viscous liquid or a solid body suddenly stops the free movement of the hand, causing the whole body to shiver.

Gemini Notebook

Source: Tales of Power / Journey to Ixtlan

TASK SET ALONE	Dismantle the fixed identity presented to the world. Sever the ties of knowing and being known by others.
WHAT THE APPRENTICE PHYSICALLY DOES	Drops established habits abruptly. Disrupts daily routines (e.g., tying the left shoe first, wearing a black cap indoors). Ceases to offer predictable emotional reactions to peers.
WHAT THE TEACHER REFUSES TO EXPLAIN	That a fixed identity makes the apprentice vulnerable, tying up all their energy in maintaining a social illusion and defending a “crummy control.”
THE PASS MARK	The apprentice achieves an evasive fluidity, acting flawlessly without ever needing to explain or justify their actions to anyone.

Gemini Notebook

Source: Journey to Ixtlan

TASK SET ALONE	Use the constant, acute awareness of imminent death as the sole gauge for any action or decision.
WHAT THE APPRENTICE PHYSICALLY DOES	Turns the head rapidly to the left shoulder to sense the unseen presence waiting just out of sight.
WHAT THE TEACHER REFUSES TO EXPLAIN	That death is an actual entity tracking every human, and that acknowledging its presence destroys the illusion of endless time.
THE PASS MARK	The apprentice acts with full commitment—"contolled folly"—while simultaneously knowing that nothing truly matters.

Gemini Notebook

Source: The Fire from Within

TASK SET ALONE	Systematically review every single interaction and person from the apprentice's entire life.
WHAT THE APPRENTICE PHYSICALLY DOES	Sits confined inside a tight wooden crate. Sweeps the head from right to left while inhaling deeply, and from left to right while exhaling.
WHAT THE TEACHER REFUSES TO EXPLAIN	That this specific breathing rhythm mechanically pulls back trapped energy left in the past and physically expels foreign energy.
THE PASS MARK	The emotional charge of the memory completely dissolves, leaving only an empty, factual record with no behavioral hooks.

Gemini Notebook

Source: The Fire from Within

TASK SET ALONE	Deliberately face a placed situation with an oppressive, dangerous person (a foreman) who holds the power of life, death, or extreme annoyance.
WHAT THE APPRENTICE PHYSICALLY DOES	Holds back all natural reactions of anger or fear. Hides behind planks if physically attacked. Maintains absolute control, discipline, and timing. Suppresses all self-pity.
WHAT THE TEACHER REFUSES TO EXPLAIN	That the tyrant is merely a mechanical device necessary to eradicate the apprentice's self-importance and force a massive perceptual shift to the "place of no pity."
THE PASS MARK	The apprentice survives the ordeal with genuine joy and serenity, completely unbothered by the abuse, never once wishing for the tyrant to die.

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THE WITHHOLDING

Source: Tales of Power

What is Withheld: The teacher deliberately conceals the final destination—the pure, indescribable, terrifying unknown.

Why: Because without an agonizingly slow, tricked preparation, the "known" (th (the ordinary mind) prefers to die of fright rather than voluntarily relinquish control.

THE FAREWELL

The Action: The leap from the cliff.

The apprenticeship ends when the teacher departs forever. The apprentice is left standing on the edge, required to intentionally venture into the unknown and reassemble their own components.

The ultimate action taken alone.

Gemini Notebook